



OAKRIDGE INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL
HYDERABAD, BACHUPALLY
A NORD ANGLIA EDUCATION SCHOOL



BACKGROUND GUIDE



UNSC

**Agenda: The Situation in the territories of
Goa, Daman and Diu — 1961**



Letter from the Executive Board

Dear Delegates,

We are excited to see you at the Oakridge International School, Bachupally, Model United Nations 2026, we have been eagerly waiting for the occasion since the last few months. Keeping in mind this might be the first voyages into the captivating realm of Model United Nations, this Background Guide is developed to help with your preliminary research for the United Nations Security Council we will be simulating with the Agenda - "The Situation in the territories of Goa, Daman and Diu - 1961".

Regardless, it is highly recommended by the Executive Board for the delegates to use this document purely for setting a direction for research of this committee and not to depend solely on the Background Guide for their research. Delegates are expected to explore various secure and authentic sources, such as UN-verified sites and reputable news channels, for their research. Delegates are also expected to familiarize with the concept of a freeze date since our committee will be running in a historic context. We understand that many of you might be overwhelmed with the amount of information being conveyed and hence encourage the delegates to ask and clarify your queries with the Executive Board without any hesitation. We also encourage you to engage critically with the tools available under the mandate of the committee to push their boundaries through meaningful policy proposals, enforceable solutions towards the global policing goals deliberated upon. Your contributions could reflect the calibers of leaders capable of confronting the complex architectures of global crime.

Lastly, we would like to mention that MUN conferences are a place for everyone to learn and grow, to eventually help make the world a better place. This starts right from you, hence we request all delegates to treat everyone equally and with respect including organising committee members, IP reporters and the Executive Board who might be present in the committee.

Wishing you a great learning experience and all the very best. We hope to have you all with us!

Sai Swarnatej

Chairperson



Points to Remember

A few important points delegates should keep in mind while preparing:

Procedure : The purpose of putting in procedural rules in any committee is to ensure a more organized and efficient debate. The committee will follow the UNA-USA Rules of Procedure. Although the Executive Board shall be fairly strict with the Rules of Procedure, the discussion of the agenda will be the main priority. So, delegates are advised not to restrict their statements due to hesitation regarding the procedure.

Foreign Policy: Following the foreign policy of one's country is the most important aspect of a Model UN Conference. This is what essentially differentiates a Model UN from other debating formats. To violate one's foreign policy without adequate reason is one of the worst mistakes a delegate can make.

Role of the Executive Board: The Executive Board is appointed to facilitate debate.

The committee shall decide the direction and flow of the debate. The delegates are the ones who constitute the committee and hence must be uninhibited while presenting their opinions/stances on any issue. However, the Executive Board may put forward questions and/or ask for clarifications at all points in time to further debate and test participants.

News Sources

This Background Guide is meant solely for research purposes and must not be cited as evidence to substantiate statements made during the conference. Evidence or proof for substantiating statements made during formal debate is acceptable from the following sources:

1. Any Reuters article which clearly makes mention of the fact or is in contradiction of the fact being stated by a delegate in the council.
2. Government Reports: These reports can be used in a similar way as the State Operated News Agencies reports and can, in all circumstances, be denied by another country.

However, a nuance is that a report that is being denied by a certain country can still be accepted by the Executive Board as credible information.

3. Reports from NGOs working with UNESCO, UNICEF and other UN bodies will be accepted. Documents from international organizations like OIC, NAFTA, SAARC, BRICS, EU, ASEAN, and ICJ may also be presented as a credible source of information.



Rules of Procedure

Although we will be explaining the RoP in detail before the commencement of the committee, please do go through this to understand the basics of the RoP.

MOTIONS

SETTING THE AGENDA

Delegate of _____ would like to raise a motion to set the agenda as _____.

ESTABLISHING A GSL

Delegate of _____ would like to raise a motion to establish the general speakers' list with an individual speaker's time of _____.

MODERATED CAUCUSES

Delegate of _____ would like to raise a motion to suspend formal debate and move into a moderated caucus on the topic _____ for a total time period of _____ minutes with individual speaker's time being _____.

UNMODERATED CAUCUSES

Delegate of _____ would like to raise a motion to suspend formal debate and move into an unmoderated caucus for a total time period of _____ minutes.

EXTENSION TO INFORMAL DEBATE

Delegate of _____ would like to raise a motion to extend the current moderated / unmoderated caucus by _____ minutes.

INTRODUCTION OF DOCUMENTATION

Delegate of _____ would like to raise a motion to introduce draft resolution [number].

VOTING ON INTRODUCED DOCUMENT(S)

Delegate of _____ would like to raise a motion to table formal debate and move into voting on [document name].



POINTS

POINT OF PERSONAL PRIVILEGE

Personal inconvenience e.g., inaudibility of some part of the speech of another Delegate **CAN** interrupt an active speaker

POINT OF ORDER

Used to point out inaccuracies in procedure and if allowed, even on factual inaccuracies within the speeches of other delegates **CANNOT** interrupt an active speaker

POINT OF PARLIAMENTARY INQUIRY

Used to clarify doubts on the rules of procedure **CANNOT** interrupt a speaker **POINT OF INFORMATION**

Used to ask questions to other delegates on their speeches **CANNOT** interrupt an active speaker

YIELDS

YIELD TO POINTS OF INFORMATION

Yielding the remaining time to other delegates so that they can question you On the speech you made. **YIELD TO ANOTHER DELEGATE**

Yielding remaining time to some specific delegate to let her/him make her/his speech. Prior consent to the yield by the other delegate is necessary.

YIELD TO THE EXECUTIVE BOARD

Yielding the remaining time to the EB. Such yielded time is deemed elapsed by the EB but not always. Such time usage is up to the discretion of the EB.



Introduction & Mandate of the United Nations Security

Council

Established by the Charter of the United Nations (UN Charter) signed in June 1945, the Charter detailed the structure and responsibilities of the United Nations, including those of the UNSC. It came into force on 24 October 1945 and established six principal organs: the General Assembly, the Security Council, the Economic and Social Council, the Trusteeship Council, the International Court of Justice and the UN Secretariat.

The United Nations Security Council (UNSC) is one of the six primary organs of the United Nations (UN), it was formed in the wake of World War II, a conflict that caused unprecedented devastation and loss of life. The main chapters pertaining to the Security Council are Chapters V, VI, VII and VIII. Chapter V deals with its composition (Article 23), functions and powers (Articles 24-26), voting (Article

27) and procedure (Articles 28-32). Chapter VI addresses Security Council action for the pacific settlement of disputes (Articles 33-38), while Chapter VII covers Security Council action with respect to threats to the peace, breaches of the peace and acts of aggression (Articles 39-51). Chapter VIII addresses Security Council interaction with regional arrangements or agencies (Articles 52-54).

The creation of the UNSC marked a significant advancement in international relations. For the first time, there was a global institution empowered to tackle threats to international peace and security. The UNSC was granted extensive powers to address these threats, including the authority to impose sanctions and authorize military action.

Composition of the UNSC

The Security Council consists of 15 members, Five permanent members (the People's Republic of China, France, the Russian Federation, the United

Kingdom and the United States); and Ten

non-permanent members elected by the General

Assembly for a two-year, non-renewable term

(Article 23 of the UN Charter).

The UNSC's structure reflects the power

dynamics at its inception. The five permanent

members were recognized as major powers

following World War II and were granted special

status within the Council. Each P5 member

possesses veto power over any substantive

decision made by the UNSC, a privilege not

extended to non-permanent members. This veto

power has significantly influenced the Council's

operations and decision-making processes.



Mandate & Powers of the UNSC

The core mandate of the Security Council, contained in Article 24 (1) of the UN Charter, gives it "primary responsibility for the maintenance of international peace and security". The Charter envisages several means for the Council to fulfil this mandate:

- Calling upon parties to settle their dispute by negotiation, enquiry, mediation, conciliation, arbitration, judicial settlement, resort to regional agencies or arrangements, or other peaceful means (Article 33);
- Investigating any dispute, or any situation which might lead to international friction or give rise to a dispute (Article 34);
- Recommending appropriate procedures or methods of adjustment (Article 36);
- Recommending such terms of settlement as it may consider appropriate (Article 37);
- Making recommendations to parties with a view to a pacific settlement of the dispute (Article 38);
- Determining the existence of any threat to the peace, breach of the peace, or act of aggression and making recommendations to maintain or restore international peace and security (Article 39);
- Calling upon the parties concerned to comply with such provisional measures as it deems necessary or desirable (Article 40);
- Deciding what measures not involving the use of force are to be employed to give effect to its decisions and calling upon UN member states to apply such measures (Article 41); The UN Charter still refers to the original permanent members, the Republic of China and the Union of Soviet Socialist Republics, although the former was replaced at the UN by the People's Republic of China on 25 October 1971, and the latter was superseded by the Russian Federation on 24 December 1991. The wording of Article 23 (1) has not been amended.
- Taking such action by air, sea, or land forces as may be necessary to maintain or restore international peace and security (Article 42);
- Negotiating and concluding special agreement(s) for armed forces, assistance and facilities with UN member states (Article 43);
- Making plans for the application of armed force with the assistance of the Military Staff Committee (Article 46);
- Encouraging the development of pacific settlement of local disputes through regional arrangements or agencies (Article 52);

Beyond these powers, the UNSC also plays a crucial role in other areas of the UN system. It recommends new member admissions to the United Nations and endorses any amendments to the UN Charter. Additionally, it is instrumental in appointing the Secretary-General, who serves as the chief administrative officer of the UN.

Concept of a Freeze Date

What Is a Freeze Date?

In a Model United Nations (Model UN or MUN) simulation, the freeze date (sometimes called a "data lock") is a specific point in time chosen by the Executive Board before the start of committee sessions. It represents the most recent date at which real-world information, events, communications, and documents are considered valid and admissible for debate and decision-making within the committee. The simulation is thus "frozen" in terms of real-world events at that point.



Why Use a Freeze Date?

- **Maintain Realism and Fairness:** Ensures all participants operate with the same set of facts and prevent last-minute "surprises" from the unfolding news cycle.
- **Level Playing Field:** Delegates prepare using materials available before the freeze date, so those with better access to breaking news do not gain an unfair advantage.
- **Preserve the Scenario:** The committee debates and resolves issues as they existed at the freeze date—even if events outside the simulation move differently.

Admissibility of Documents and Proof

- Any documents, news articles, government statements, speeches, or statistics released or made public after the freeze date are not admissible as evidence or proof in committee discussions.
- **Proof Standard:** Delegates may cite only sources or documents that would have been available to real diplomats at the time marked by the freeze date.
- **Examples of Inadmissible Evidence:**
 - A UN resolution passed after the freeze date;
 - A news story breaking after the freeze date;
 - Newly declassified government papers not yet public as of the freeze.

Using Post-Freeze-Date Events as Hypotheticals

Although official debate and documentation must stick to the facts as of the freeze date, committees can:

- **Discuss Potential Scenarios:** Delegates may refer to post-freeze events not as facts, but as hypothetical possibilities to prepare for, or to help inform risk assessment and contingency planning.
- **Guide Policy Decisions:** Committees can entertain "what if" discussions based on later real-world developments—as long as these are framed as hypothetical future possibilities, not as already-occurred facts within the committee's timeline.
- **Drafting Resolutions:** Proposals may include preventative or adaptive measures in anticipation of situations similar to those that occurred after the freeze date—but delegates should not claim foreknowledge of those events.

Colonialism

Colonialism is a practice of domination, which involves the subjugation of one people to another. At least since the Crusades and the conquest of the Americas, political theorists have used theories of justice, contract, and natural law to both criticize and justify European domination. In the nineteenth century, the contradiction between liberal ideals and colonial practice became particularly acute, as the dominion of Europe over the rest of the world reached its zenith.



Colonialism is not a modern phenomenon. World history is full of examples of one society gradually expanding by incorporating adjacent territory and settling its people on newly conquered territory. In the sixteenth century, colonialism changed decisively because of technological developments in navigation that began to connect more remote parts of the world. The modern European colonial project emerged when it became possible to move large numbers of people across the ocean and to maintain political control in spite of geographical dispersion.

Self-Determination vs. Paternalism

Starting off by Defining Self-Determination and Paternalism, Self-determination is the right for individuals or peoples to freely make choices about their own lives, political status, and cultural future without external interference and Paternalism involves one group or authority overriding or limiting another's choices, justified by claims that it is "for their own good." We the executive board expect the delegates to define their stances in the case of annexation of Goa, and raise the philosophical question of which ideology better suits the needs of the people of Goa?

Questions we expect the committee to address

- Should all peoples have the right to self-determination, even if their practices are the same as the colonizer's values?
- Do colonial rulers have the right to dictate what qualifies as legitimate governance or social organization?

Common Justification arguments

Self Determination - In the struggle against colonialism, self-determination became the rallying cry for nations and peoples to reclaim sovereignty and cultural integrity, challenging the imposed rule of colonizing powers

Paternalism - Colonial powers often invoked paternalism to defend their actions, arguing that colonized peoples were "not ready" for self-government, thus necessitating external oversight until they were "civilized" or "developed" enough

The core of the self-determination vs. paternalism debate is a clash between respect for autonomy and the impulse to protect or guide others. While self-determination is now widely endorsed as critical to justice and dignity (especially in postcolonial contexts), the boundaries of justified intervention remain a subject of philosophical dispute—with an increasing emphasis on empowering self-authorship and resisting all but the most essential paternalistic measures.

Colonialism and Economic Development

Colonialist empires have always justified their actions using a paternalistic ideology, While this has been proven false for the British territories of India; Goa has seen marginally better economic development, under such circumstances is colonial power justified? Especially when the cultural links of Goans and Portuguese have been culturally syncretised.

10 During the earlier phase of Portuguese rule, particularly in the 16th and 17th centuries, Goa was renowned for its urban prosperity. It became a vibrant trading hub, sometimes called "Golden Goa," and was considered one of the richest urban centers in the Indian Ocean. The Portuguese developed Goa as a focal point for East-West trade, using it as a secure port and passage for spices, silks, and other global commodities, integrating Goa into world commerce in a way few other Indian ports were at the time. The Portuguese administration implemented a relatively structured municipal governance system compared to other colonial regimes. They also launched a public school system, resulting in higher urban literacy rates in some communities relative to rural India under the British. The Portuguese introduced new crops and agricultural methods—such as cashew, tobacco, and improved irrigation—that transformed segments of Goan agriculture and diversified rural incomes. Investments in architecture, urban planning, and cultural institutions (including hospitals and schools) gave Goa a cosmopolitan character and an urban infrastructure rare for a colony its size.



British rule engineered a “drain of wealth” from India, reorganizing the economy to supply cheap raw materials to Britain while flooding Indian markets with British manufactures. This approach deindustrialized India's historic urban centers and stripped artisans and weavers of livelihoods. British land revenue policies imposed severe burdens on Indian peasants, leading to widespread rural poverty, indebtedness, and recurring famines—especially in the 18th and 19th centuries. Deliberate suppression of Indian manufacturing and crafts eliminated India's handicraft and textile industries, ensuring dependency on British goods. Infrastructure such as railways and telegraphs, often cited by British apologists, primarily served the extraction of resources and movement of British merchandise, not local development. **Questions we expect the Committee to address**

- Are the cases of Portuguese Goa and British India Equally comparable?
- Does the cultural development in Goa have any symbolic value? If yes, then how does it help to maintain a colonialistic government?

While both colonial regimes ultimately prioritized imperial interests, Portugal's record in Goa can be argued—by its defenders—as more conducive to early urban development and cultural transformation, whereas the British Raj's policies triggered deindustrialization and catastrophic economic decline for the majority of the Indian subcontinent.

Universalism vs. Relativism and Colonialism

Moral Universalism holds that there are objective, universal standards of morality that apply across all cultures and contexts. In the context of colonialism, universalists would claim that principles such as freedom, autonomy, and human rights are universally valid, making the subjugation and exploitation inherent to colonialism inherently wrong—no matter the cultural or historical context.

Moral Relativism, on the other hand, contends that moral judgments are always informed by culture, history, and societal values. For a moral relativist, whether colonialism is considered morally wrong or acceptable depends on the values and beliefs specific to each society or period. What one society deems oppressive, another might rationalize as progress or duty, and there is no single, objective moral standard by which to judge all instances of colonialism.



Questions we expect the Committee to address

- Can moral judgments about colonialism be universal, or must they always be context-dependent?
- Who has the authority to define "progress" or "civilization"?

In the case of Goa, should the idea of Universalism be taken up or Relativism, how does the ideology of judging colonialism change the reasoning and hence the outcome of what is right and what is wrong. Universalism might support India and Relativism might support Portugal. If we adopt either of them for evaluating the case of Goa, shouldn't it mean that all other colonial territories which gained Independence must be re-evaluated?



Importance of NATO in the Situation

NATO's Article 5 is the mutual defense clause stating that an armed attack against one member is considered an attack against all. However, its application is geographically limited as defined by Article 6 of the North Atlantic Treaty. The specific language for the territorial scope comes from Article 6 of the North Atlantic Treaty, which precisely limits Article 5 protection to these regions. The intention was to keep mutual defense limited to the Euro-Atlantic area and avoid obligations relating to colonies or territories outside these zones. Article 5 applies to armed attacks occurring in the following areas:

- Territory of any NATO member in Europe
- Territory of any NATO member in North America
- Territory of Turkey
- Islands under the jurisdiction of any NATO member in the North Atlantic area, north of the Tropic of Cancer

One key detail to be noticed is Goa and Daman & Diu do not lie north of the Tropic of Cancer, Article 6 of the NATO Treaty was specifically designed to avoid conflict in colonial territories and enclaves yet Portuguese had requested NATO's assistance.

Questions we expect the Committee to address

- Should NATO take a more aggressive stance and resort to military action?
- Why did NATO not intervene even though the major powers like UK, USA, France have all condemned India's action?

NATO's Article 5 protection is strictly limited to the European and North American territories of the allies, Turkey, certain North Atlantic islands north of the Tropic of Cancer, and their forces/vessels/aircraft in or over these areas and the Mediterranean. Most overseas or colonial territories outside these parameters are excluded from NATO's mutual defense guarantee.



Timeline

Date & Time

Event / Milestone

1953

Diplomatic withdrawal - India recalled mission from Lisbon, froze diplomatic ties

1954

Travel restrictions - Visa and border controls paralyzed movement and transport

1954

Economic embargo - Blocked supply of goods and trade with Portuguese India

1954

Dockworker shipping boycott - Refused services to ships trading with Portuguese territories

1951 - 61

International advocacy - Raised issues at the UN, lobbied for diplomatic pressure

11 Dec 1961

Indian troops mobilized near Goa, operational orders issued 12 Dec 1961

Borders closed to civilians

17 Dec 1961, 09:45

First firefight at Maulinguém (Northeast Goa) 18 Dec 1961, 04:00

Artillery barrage, Portuguese destroy bridges 18 Dec 1961, 06:00

Main ground, air, and naval assaults commence; rapid advances on all fronts

18 Dec 1961, Evening

Most of Goa secured by Indian forces

The Current Freeze Date is established at 11:59 PM (IST) on 18th December, 1961 *Map for reference ONLY **Not to scale 14



Ethical Question of Annexation of Goa, Daman & Diu

India's military annexation of the Portuguese territories of Goa, Daman, and Diu in 1961 is often criticized as unethical from several perspectives rooted in international law and moral principles. Firstly, the action violated the sovereignty and territorial integrity of Portugal, a recognized state, by launching a unilateral armed invasion without exhausting all peaceful diplomatic means. While numerous nations considered Goa, Daman & Diu to be colonial enclaves of Portugal, the Portuguese government held no distinction between overseas territories and Portugal itself.

This military aggression contravened the principles enshrined in the United Nations Charter, which advocate for conflict resolution through dialogue and respect for established international borders. Secondly, the use of force disregarded the colonial legal status and diplomatic norms.

Additionally, the operation involved disproportionate use of military force against relatively small garrisons, raising humanitarian concerns. Critics argue that annexing these enclaves through warfare, rather than negotiation or international mediation, set a precedent for resolving territorial disputes through conflict rather than law.

Furthermore, the annexation risked undermining the principle of non-intervention and respect for existing treaties, destabilizing trust in international agreements. Even proponents of Indian unification concede that the ethical legitimacy of the operation is diminished by its instrumental use of force, sidelining international diplomacy and respecting colonial legacies in a manner that could have respected evolving decolonization norms more fully.

India withdrew its diplomatic mission from Lisbon on 11 June 1953 after Portugal refused to discuss the future of its Indian territories or respond to Indian diplomatic communications. India also requested Portugal to close its delegation in New Delhi, resulting in a de facto freeze in bilateral diplomatic relations.

Questions we expect the Committee to address

- Was the use of military force ethically justified in this context, given the long duration of colonial rule?
- Did the annexation reflect the genuine will and self-determination of the Goan people?
- Was the principle of non-intervention violated, and if so, were there ethical grounds to override it?

In 1954, India imposed strict visa controls between its territory and Portuguese India, severely restricting movement and transport between Goa, Daman, Diu, and the Indian mainland. This act paralyzed normal travel and trade to and from Portuguese-held territories and India instituted an economic blockade, cutting off the supply of essential goods—including food, fuel, and other materials—to Portuguese India. The embargo was meant to isolate the territories economically and encourage local resistance to Portuguese rule. The Indian Union of Dockers (dock workers' union) enforced a boycott on all shipping bound for Portuguese India starting in 1954. This further weakened maritime supply lines to the enclaves by disrupting cargo and trade shipments.